LANCE

An autonomous and verifiable auditor for IoT/IIoT networks

Progress report — NATO SPS G6259

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Status: work in progress.

The objective

An auditor that explores, identifies, verifies and reports.

Under which conditions
rather than which model prevails

Identical tools and budget
for both approaches

Evidence, not assertion
recomputed from the log

Model training is not a current priority.

The instrument

Laboratory networks with known ground truth

Platform conducts the audit

Benchmark assesses the result

The model is one component among them.

A run constitutes a measurement only against known ground truth.

What constitutes a finding

“I have read another organisation's data.”

✕ **Not admitted**

The request and its response contain the data.

✓ **Admitted**

The same trial is conducted on a healthy and on a vulnerable network. A finding reported on the healthy one is recorded as an error.

The finding is recomputed from the log; the conclusion is never taken on trust.

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Current status

Both approaches succeed on every configuration.

Rule-based 6 / 6



Model-based 6 / 6



The instrument does not discriminate between them.

This is a limitation of the instrument, not of the model.

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The objective restated as hypotheses

H1 **Connected devices**

a link absent from public inputs

H2 **Heterogeneous formats**

a representation no parser covers

H3 **Novel contracts**

rights stated in unseen documentation

H4 **Vendor semantics**

a field whose meaning is only documented

H5 **Ambiguous refusals**

resuming the audit after a refusal

H6 **Hostile content**

an instruction obeyed from observed content

H1–H5 quantify a possible gain. **H6 quantifies a risk.**

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A control task before testing the model

A control task, simple enough to be solved without inference. Both approaches are required to pass.

	model ✗	model ✓
script ✓	**a defect in the instrument**	**valid — the hypotheses may be read**
script ✗	beyond the reach of this instrument	**a gain, or a coverage gap**

Only a control that the script and the model both pass permits the hypotheses to be read.

Implemented and tested offline. The laboratory run remains outstanding.

What we cannot claim

✕	**No general advantage**	No hypothesis has yet been executed.
✕	**No confidence interval**	Three repetitions yield a dispersion, not a sample.
✕	**No admitted evidence**	The metric definition is not frozen.

A successful run is not a measurement: one early run reported success while every model arm had failed.

Next steps

1. Execute V0 on a held-out instance
2. Develop a parameterisable test harness
3. Build the scenario families for H2, H3 and H4
4. Deploy a reproducible platform

Support requested

- access to real vendor artifacts
- an adversarial review of the register

Order follows conditions, not dates.

AsiaCCS 2027 — submission deadline 11 December 2026 (AoE).

Reserve — declared coverage gaps

- Physical impact and functional safety
- Device fragility under probing
- Real fleet scale
- Proprietary industrial protocols that are not simulated
- Complete multi-step exploitation chains
- Abstention and calibration
- Generic IT scenarios, deliberately excluded

A benchmark that states its gaps is stronger than one that claims full coverage.